Pakistan Men's National Football Team

Diamond Jubilee International Tournament 2026 - Performance Analysis

Tournament Summary

Pakistan competed in the Diamond Jubilee International Tournament 2026, playing four matches against Bangladesh, the Maldives, and Afghanistan twice, once in the group stage and again in the tournament final. Pakistan won the tournament, remaining unbeaten throughout and ending a 74-year wait for an international tournament trophy.

Pakistan recorded 3 wins and 1 draw while scoring 7 goals, conceding 0 goals and keeping 4 clean sheets. Pakistan started the tournament with a goalless draw against Bangladesh, who were playing their U-23 squad, but Pakistan improved and showed positive progression throughout the tournament as they won 3-0 against Maldives, then 2-0 against Afghanistan, and lastly the final against Afghanistan 2-0 to claim the title.

Pakistan balanced all departments while maintaining 48.3% possession across the tournament. Passing accuracy was the most impressive number, at 75.9%, showing a controlled, composed, and improved side.

Tactical System

Pakistan used 2 formations: 5-3-2 and 5-2-3. When using 5-3-2, they shifted to 3-4-1-2 during offensive transitions and remained in 5-3-2 during defensive transitions. During 5-2-3, Pakistan used 5-4-1 in defensive transitions and 3-4-3 during attacking transitions. 5-3-2 was Pakistan's most suitable formation. This formation allowed Pakistan to have balanced control in both transitions. Pakistan having numbers in their back line and having a mid block helped them a lot, and while attacking, the front 3 being wide to hit the opponents on the counter. This setup favoured Adil Nabi, who can play long balls to wingers from anywhere on the pitch, and Otis Khan on the wing, using his pace and dribbling to move past the defenders into the final third. 5-2-3 formation allowed Pakistan to hug the sideline effectively.

Match by Match Analysis

Pakistan vs Bangladesh: The first game of the tournament, playing against the U-23 side of Bangladesh, it was a goalless draw. Pakistan controlled possession and maintained great passing accuracy of 81.4%, but with poor final third conversions. Pakistan played most of the match against a 10-man Bangladesh after they received a red card. Chance creation and finishing were very poor, as only 3 shots were on target in 90 minutes. Yousuf Butt, the goalkeeper of Pakistan, made some great saves to keep the match goalless. Overall, this opener was a very poor performance from Pakistan. Pakistan used a 5-3-2 formation in this match.

Pakistan vs Maldives: Pakistan again controlled possession and maintained excellent passing accuracy while improving final third conversions. Pakistan showed improvement from the first match, and this match showed an overall team performance. Pakistan controlled this match very comfortably against the hosts. Pakistan used a 5-3-2 formation with some tweaks, as they played a bit higher up the pitch, moving their back line a bit higher up the pitch. Pakistan gave a great display and won it 3-0. Goals were scored by Umar Nawaz, Abdul Samad, and Harun Hamid.

Pakistan vs Afghanistan: The last game of the group stage, where Pakistan shifted to their best formation, 5-2-3, where we controlled less possession but created moments, hitting them on the break using width. Pakistan again showed a great defensive display by not conceding in this game. Umar Nawaz and Harun Hamid were the goal scorers in this game. Again keeping a clean sheet, Pakistan won the game 2-0.

Pakistan vs Afghanistan(FINAL): Same system: 5-2-3, simple, direct, and defensive display. Pakistan had all the momentum in the final, keeping less ball by being in shape, marking every area, and playing on the counter. Finished final third chances very well, with Shayek Dost scoring an overhead kick and Harun Hamid scoring in the last minute. Pakistan won 2-0, another clean sheet, but this time winning the final.

Player Performance Analysis

Pakistan's success was built on a well-structured team system in which every player had a clear role. Players made valuable defensive and offensive contributions, allowing the team to perform consistently across every phase of the game.

Abdullah Iqbal was the standout passer of the tournament, completing 94.2% of his attempts, while Adil Nabi carried the highest passing volume (214 attempts), underlining his role in dictating tempo from a deeper or central position.

Tackles Won (leaders): Haris Zeb, Ali Agha, Hayyan and Muhammad Fazal were the team's most active tacklers, with Haris Zeb winning the most duels of the ball on the ground.

Interceptions (leaders): Abdullah Iqbal, Easah Suliman, Haris Zeb, Mohib Ullah and Muhammad Fazal all made repeated interceptions, showing a defensively disciplined unit reading the game well in front of the back five.

Duels Won (leaders): Haris Zeb, Easah Suliman and Mohib Ullah won the most individual duels, reinforcing their importance to the team's defensive solidity, which produced a tournament-wide total of 130 defensive actions and zero goals conceded.

Mohib Ullah and Abdullah Shah were the two most dominant aerial presences, each winning six aerial duels, a key factor in Pakistan's defensive stability from set pieces and long balls.

Harun Hamid was the tournament's top scorer with three goals and also led the shooting-accuracy charts (4/5 shots on target, 80%). Umar Nawaz and Shayek Dost both converted their shots at a 100% on-target rate from limited attempts (2/2 each), while Otis Khan combined goal threat with the most assists (2) in the squad, confirming his role as the team's chief creative outlet.

Team Analysis

Unbeaten and clean-sheet campaign: Pakistan won the tournament without losing a single match and without conceding a single goal in four games the clearest indicator of defensive organisation under the tactical setups used.

Possession was not always the priority: Pakistan dominated possession against Bangladesh (57.4%) and Maldives (55%), but deliberately ceded it to Afghanistan in both meetings (34.9% and 45.9%), instead relying on a compact 5-4-1/5-2-3 defensive block and quick transitions to win both games 2-0.

Final-third efficiency improved as the tournament progressed: shot accuracy rose from 25% (vs Bangladesh) to 45.45% (vs Maldives) and settled at 50% in both matches against Afghanistan, coinciding with Pakistan's most clinical performances.

Goal Scorers: Harun Hamid (3 goals) and Umar Nawaz (2 goals) accounted for five of Pakistan's seven goals, supported by single strikes from Shayek Dost and Abdul Samad.

Otis Khan as creator: with two assists and a share of the team's shots, Otis Khan was central to Pakistan's attacking phases, frequently combining with Abdullah Iqbal and Shayek Dost in the final third, as reflected in the assist map.

Defensive Unit: Haris Zeb, Abdullah Iqbal, Mohib Ullah, Easah Suliman and Muhammad Fazal repeatedly featured across tackles, interceptions and duels won, forming the backbone of a defence that did not concede in the tournament.

Pakistan's Diamond Jubilee International Cup 2026 campaign was built on tactical flexibility, defensive discipline and a small number of efficient attacking players. The team adapted its approach match to match controlling games against Bangladesh and Maldives through possession, and absorbing pressure against Afghanistan through a compact low block and swift counter-attacks. An unbeaten, clean-sheet run through four matches, capped by a 2-0 win over Afghanistan in the final, represents one of the team's greatest recent achievements.